Examine each other

Half an hour with a fellow student, in your own time. You sit the exam once and you set it once. Nothing is recorded, scored or handed in. The point is that the format is not new to you on the day of your real oral, and that you find out now, not then, where your own answers run out.

SET UP 2 minutes

- **Pair up with someone who was not your assignment partner.** You should not know their code. In the real oral the examiner did not write it either. Meet in person or on Teams: sharing your screen in a Teams call is exactly how the real oral runs.
- **Three works too.** Run three shorter rounds of 10 minutes: each person is examined once, examines once and observes once. The observer only listens, then joins the feedback.
- **Candidate:** your notebooks open, your code open in an editor, your programs built. Exactly as in the real exam.
- **Examiner:** the Sample questions page and the scoring card open. You hold the clock.
- **Scope:** the assignments you have handed in. Now that is A1 and A2. Do it again with all four in the weeks before the orals: there is no better rehearsal.

ONE ROUND 12 minutes of exam, then 3 of feedback; swap roles and repeat

1	**Showcase**	~2 min	candidate	Show one result you are proud of and explain it. The examiner then asks one follow-up: why does it come out like that?
2	**Own code**	~5 min	examiner	The examiner picks the assignment, not the candidate. Start from "show me where your code computes ...", then ask why it is done that way. Take a sample question for that assignment and ask it about the candidate's own code and numbers, not in the abstract.
3	**Tests**	~3 min	examiner	Another assignment. How do you know this result is right? What does that test prove, and which bug could still slip through it?
4	**Predict**	~2 min	examiner	If we change X, what happens to Y? The candidate commits to an answer first, then reasons it through.

HOW TO EXAMINE

- **Climb.** When an answer is solid, go one level up: describe (L1), explain why (L2), predict and connect (L3), critique and design (L4). You are looking for where the answers run out, not staying where they are comfortable.
- **Stay anchored.** "Show me that in your code." "Which plot shows that?" "What number did you get?"
- **Do not help, and do not argue.** Ten seconds of silence is fine. If the candidate is stuck, move on to a fresh question; the real examiner does the same.
- **You do not need to know the answer yourself.** Judge whether the reasoning holds together. A good question you cannot answer is still a good question.

FEEDBACK 3 minutes, examiner to candidate

- **A rough score per dimension,** D1 to D4, using the anchors on the scoring card. While only A1 and A2 are done, D4 (methods landscape) may stay "not probed".
- **The question where the answers ran out,** and the depth level reached before that.
- **One thing to prepare** before the real oral.

The observer, if there is one, adds what the examiner missed. Write the feedback down for yourself.

Being the examiner is half the exercise. Asking a good "why" about someone else's code teaches you which questions your own code has to survive.